

night without waking people up). Before the Chrysalis, domovoi should be people with strong senses of family; they might not all be parents, of course, but they bond with the people around them. Domovoi make good housekeepers, teachers, counselors, and security guards.

Finally, Matt thinks about the magic of the domovoi, with an eye toward what might make for interesting Birthrights. Their oracular ability is one idea, though Matt would have to be careful not to tread on the toes of the Soothsay Art. Their proclivity for stealth and silence is another possibility, as is their propensity for protecting sleeper Dreamers.

Step Two: Role in the Dreaming

Clearly, domovoi stem from some of the same dreams as boggans (having a helper around to take care of some of the housework), but also a deeper fear of protecting one's family. The domovoi, after all, watched over sleeping people, and therefore come from dreams of safety and guardianship.

That's the easy part; the more challenging question is how the domovoi fit into Kithain history. They're pretty obviously commoners, after all, so where were they during the Accordance War and other recent events? Matt decides that they adopted the Changeling Way easily and willingly in the wake of the Shattering, and weathered the Interregnum the way they always had — sticking closer to their adopted mortal families and being helpful. When the Resurgence happened, some domovoi welcome the sidhe back (they'd never had any particular conflict with their "leaders," since their focus was generally on humans) while others were largely indifferent. Few domovoi, though, were passionate combatants in the war. This led to a reputation for being neutral (at best) and cowards (at worst) in the eyes of other Kithain.

With regards to the two courts, Matt decides that Seelie domovoi are gentle teachers and helpers, much more prone to protecting sleepers and cleaning the house up than to making their presence known. Unseelie domovoi, on the other hand, are the ones more likely to send obtuse warnings in the form of omens to their families, and if the families can't figure them out, well, that's hardly the changeling's problem.

What about in mortal society? Domovoi obviously don't have to spend every waking moment in their family's house; if they did, they wouldn't be suitable characters. Matt decides that a changeling domovoi adopts a given family and ingratiates himself as a friend, neighbor, and confidante. The domovoi then swears an oath to the family, which the family seals (often unknowingly) by offering the domovoi a gift or a meal. The domovoi is then bound that family as long as it lives in that dwelling. Matt figures the domovoi could draw Glamour from the family's house like a freehold, but that's probably a Birthright.

A domovoi's role in a motley is probably best served in navigating mortal society. Domovoi understand it because they've watched that society change over the centuries. Domovoi could also be good watchdogs for nascent changelings about to enter the Chrysalis.



How to Use This Process: Storytellers

The kith creation process is geared toward creating a kith that is playable — that is, that works to make player-controlled characters. As such, using it to make new supporting cast beings (Thallain, for instance) works, but the priorities need to be slightly different with regards to mechanics.

A Storyteller character is a plot device, a method for the troupe's characters to endure challenges, to engage in stirring dialog, and ultimately to tell their story. As such, a Frailty for such a character shouldn't be a roleplaying challenge so much as a motivation for their actions. Consider, for example, the Brand of the Iconoclast (p. 359), a type of Dauntain that must destroy some piece of the Dreaming every day. Since they're not designed as characters for players, you're not going to run stories in which the Dauntain has to decide which Treasure to break or tries to find some acceptable piece of magic to ruin. Instead, that need to destroy the Dreaming informs the character's actions and brings him into conflict with the players' characters.

Likewise, if you're designing Birthrights, using Advantages and Acumen over Magic can make less work for you; it'll make the characters tougher in terms of their Trait ratings, but the players' characters have plenty of other advantages (the story is *about* them, which makes a huge difference) to offset the numbers. And, in play, it means you don't have to worry about remembering what the system is for a particular Birthright.

Finally, this process works very well if you decide you want to allow a player to take on the role of a reformed Thallain, or Dauntain, or dark-kin. Just consider the character's "kith" through this lens, as though you were creating a new type of changeling. Use the mechanics that work, and tweak the ones that aren't geared toward player-controlled characters. Mostly it's a question of changing focus and priority; Storyteller characters are meant to be challenges for players' characters, so the shift just needs to recognize that the story is now about this character, rather than happening around him.



Step Three: Birthrights

Matt already has one idea for a Birthright: **Adopted Family**. He wants each domovoi to be able to draw on its family's dwelling like a freehold. The Storyteller agrees, and says that the domovoi can regain Glamour (up to three points in a story) by spending a night with the family and performing some service for them. This is obviously a Magic Birthright.